

Sleep Hygiene

The afternoon-to-pillow routine, a bedroom audit, a 7-night quality tracker and partner sync ·

Module 4, Training 6

Why

Sleep disruption is linked to irregular cycles and lower fertility (Kloss et al., *Sleep Medicine Reviews*); melatonin, made in darkness, is found in the fluid around developing eggs where it acts as an antioxidant (Tamura et al., *Journal of Pineal Research*); light-emitting screens before bed suppress melatonin and delay the body clock (Chang et al., *PNAS*); one short night increases craving for high-calorie food (Greer et al., *Nature Communications*); a warm bath or shower 1–2 hours before bed shortens time to fall asleep (Haghighyegh et al., *Sleep Medicine Reviews*); men sleeping 7–7.5 h had the best semen quality (Chen et al., *Fertility and Sterility*).

The routine (40 XP: implement it)

WHEN	DO	TICK
Morning	Daylight within an hour of waking (the walk from Module 3)	☐
By noon	Last caffeine (half-life 5–6 hours)	☐
Evening	Alcohol none/minimal · dinner 2–3 h before bed · vigorous exercise earlier in the day	☐
90 min out	Warm bath or shower	☐
60 min out	Screens off and out of the room (phone charges in the kitchen; a cheap alarm clock replaces it) · bedtime stretch / yoga short version / 4-7-8 · printed book	☐
10 min out	Gratitude share or three lines in the journal ("file the day")	☐
Lights out	Same time nightly, within 30 min · 7–9 hours	☐

Can't sleep after 20 minutes? Get up, sit somewhere dim, 5 minutes of the body scan, return when drowsy. **Worry won't let go?** Write it down with an appointment: "I'll deal with this tomorrow at 10 a.m."

Bedroom audit

- ☐ Dark: blackout curtains or eye mask; charger lights covered
- ☐ Cool: about 18–20 °C / 65–68 °F
- ☐ Quiet, or steady white noise
- ☐ Bed for sleep and intimacy only
- ☐ Phone charges outside the room (both partners)
- ☐ Alarm clock on the nightstand instead

Partner sync agreement

Lights out by _____ (within 30 min of each other) · phones in the kitchen from _____ · shared wind-down: _____ · Signed _____ / _____

Snoring, gasping or pauses in breathing during sleep, in either partner: see a doctor. Sleep apnoea affects hormones and fertility in men and women and is treatable.

7-night quality tracker (30 XP)

NIGHT	CAFFEINE AFTER NOON?	SCREENS OFF BY	BATH/ SHOWER?	LIGHTS OUT	WOKE	HOURS	QUALITY 1–10	NEXT- MORNING MOOD 1–10
1			☐					
2			☐					
3			☐					
4			☐					
5			☐					
6			☐					
7			☐					

Nights I kept the routine: _____ · average quality on those nights: _____ · on the others: _____

When to see a doctor

Poor sleep for more than a few weeks despite the routine, or insomnia lasting three months: insomnia is treatable, and the first-line treatment is a structured program (CBT-I), not a pill. Ask your doctor.

.....

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.